
Amazon Marketing Cloud

Feature Guide for Ads Optimization

A focused guide on what Amazon Marketing Cloud is, how its APIs work, and the full list of monitoring, optimization, and automation features you can build using AMC to help sellers increase their Amazon sales.

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1. What is Amazon Marketing Cloud?

Amazon Marketing Cloud (AMC) is a free, privacy-safe analytics environment from Amazon Ads. It works as a "clean room" where you can analyze detailed, event-level data about how shoppers interact with ads across all Amazon advertising channels — Sponsored Products, Sponsored Brands, Sponsored Display, and Amazon DSP.

While standard Amazon Ads reporting gives you surface-level numbers like clicks and ACOS, AMC lets you see the complete customer journey: from the first ad impression, through product page views and add-to-cart events, all the way to purchase. You query this data using SQL.

Key Facts

- **Privacy-Safe:** All data is anonymized. Results are aggregated with a minimum group of 100 users. No personal information is ever exposed.
- **Cross-Channel:** Combines Sponsored Ads, DSP, Attribution, and retail purchase data in one place.
- **SQL-Based:** You write SQL queries to extract insights, build audiences, and generate reports.
- **Free:** Available at no cost to advertisers running Sponsored Ads or DSP. First-party paid signals are also free through Dec 2026.
- **25-Month Lookback:** Analyze up to 25 months of historical ad data.
- **API + UI Access:** Available through a web interface or programmatically via APIs.
- **1-2 Day Data Delay:** Data is not real-time. There is a privacy-driven lag of 1-2 days.

2. How AMC is Different from Standard Reporting

Standard Amazon Ads reporting tells you what happened. AMC tells you why it happened and what to do about it. Here is a side-by-side comparison:

What You Want to Know	Standard Reporting	With AMC
Which ad drove the sale?	Last-click only	Full multi-touch journey
Are my ads reaching new customers?	Not available	New-to-Brand metrics
Are shoppers seeing my ads too often?	Basic frequency data	Per-segment frequency analysis
Is my ad spend actually incremental?	Not available	Incrementality measurement
Who abandoned their cart?	Not available	Cart abandoner audiences you can retarget
How do my ad channels work together?	Siloed channel	Cross-channel path-to-conversion
Can I target based on behavior?	Keyword/product targeting	Custom audiences from shopping behavior
Which customer segments are most valuable?	Not available	Lifetime value and purchase history segments

3. AMC APIs at a Glance

AMC APIs are part of the Amazon Ads API family. They use OAuth 2.0 (Login with Amazon) and follow the same patterns as Sponsored Ads and DSP APIs. Here are the five API categories and what each one enables:

API	What It Does	Features It Powers
Reporting API	Run SQL queries on-demand or on a schedule to extract insights from AMC data	Custom reports, attribution reports, AS/FC data analysis, NTB tracking
Audiences API	Create custom audiences from SQL queries	Carpet targeting, refresh rules, less sensitive audiences, closed DSP or
Workflow API	Schedule recurring queries and audience refreshes	Ad refresh rules (daily/weekly audience refresh, scheduled
Signal Mgmt API	Upload first-party data (hashed CRM data)	Enhanced audience targeting, CRM-based segmentation
Administration API	Manage AMC instances, user access, and permissions	Multi-brand management, team permissions

Note: As of Feb 2026, Amazon also offers an MCP (Model Context Protocol) server in open beta with 50+ tools including amc_ prefixed tools. This can power AI-driven natural language features on top of AMC data.

4. Monitoring Features

These features give sellers deep visibility into how their ads are performing — far beyond what standard Amazon reports show.

4.1 Full-Funnel Customer Journey Dashboard

Shows the complete path shoppers take: ad impression → product page view → add-to-cart → purchase. Sellers can see exactly where shoppers drop off and which touchpoints matter most for each product. This replaces guesswork with a clear picture of the buying funnel.

API: Reporting API — path-to-conversion queries

4.2 Multi-Touch Attribution Reports

Instead of crediting only the last ad a shopper clicked before buying, this shows how every ad interaction contributed to the sale. A shopper might see a Sponsored Brand video, then click a Sponsored Product ad, then finally buy after a DSP retargeting ad. All three touchpoints get appropriate credit, revealing the true value of upper-funnel campaigns.

API: Reporting API — custom attribution queries

4.3 Cross-Channel Ad Frequency Monitor

Tracks how many times the same shoppers see ads across all channels. Alerts sellers when frequency gets too high (causing ad fatigue and wasted spend) or too low (missing opportunities). Shows frequency-to-conversion curves so sellers can see their sweet spot.

API: Reporting API — frequency analysis queries

4.4 New-to-Brand (NTB) Tracker

Shows what percentage of purchases come from completely new customers versus repeat buyers. Essential for brands focused on market share growth. Breaks down NTB rate by campaign, ad type, and product so sellers know which campaigns are actually bringing in fresh customers.

API: Reporting API — NTB dimension queries

4.5 Audience Overlap Dashboard

Visualizes how audiences overlap between different campaigns and ad types. If two campaigns are reaching 80% of the same shoppers, the seller is paying double for the same eyeballs. This helps them consolidate or differentiate targeting.

API: Reporting API — audience overlap queries

4.6 Campaign Health Alerts

Combines AMC insights with standard metrics to flag problems automatically: declining NTB rate, rising frequency without conversion lift, increasing overlap between campaigns, or budget going to non-incremental audiences. Sends notifications before problems grow.

API: Reporting API (scheduled) + Sponsored Ads API

4.7 Year-over-Year Performance Comparison

Using AMC's 25-month lookback window, sellers can compare current campaign performance to the same period last year. Useful for identifying seasonal trends, measuring growth, and planning budget around peak periods like Prime Day or Q4.

API: Reporting API — extended lookback queries

5. Optimization Features

These features help sellers take action on AMC insights to improve campaign performance and reduce wasted spend.

5.1 Incrementality-Based Budget Allocation

Identifies which campaigns drive truly incremental sales (sales that would NOT have happened without the ad) versus campaigns that reach shoppers who would have bought anyway. Recommends shifting budget from low-incrementality to high-incrementality campaigns. This alone can save 15-20% of wasted ad spend for many sellers.

API: Reporting API — incrementality measurement queries

5.2 Custom Audience Builder

Lets sellers create targeted audience segments based on actual shopping behavior. Examples: shoppers who viewed a product 3+ times but didn't buy, shoppers who bought from a competitor, or shoppers who clicked an ad but didn't visit the product page. These audiences can be pushed directly into DSP or Sponsored Ads campaigns for precise targeting.

API: Audiences API + Reporting API

5.3 Optimal Frequency Finder

Analyzes the relationship between how often a shopper sees an ad and how likely they are to convert, broken down by product and ad type. Outputs the ideal frequency range. For example, if data shows that conversions peak at 4 exposures and drop after 7, the seller knows exactly where to set their frequency cap.

API: Reporting API — frequency-conversion analysis

5.4 Path-to-Conversion Optimizer

Identifies the most effective sequence of ad touchpoints. For example, data might show that shoppers who first see a Sponsored Brand video, then a Sponsored Product ad, convert at 3x the rate of those who only see search ads. Sellers can then design their campaign structure to replicate winning paths.

API: Reporting API — path analysis queries

5.5 High-Value Segment Targeting with Lookalikes

Finds the seller's most profitable customer segments based on purchase history and lifetime value. Then generates lookalike audiences of new shoppers who behave similarly but haven't bought yet. This is one of the highest-ROI uses of AMC — one brand saw 100% new-to-brand purchase rate from lookalike campaigns.

API: Audiences API (lookalike) + Reporting API

5.6 Ad Spend Waste Detector

Flags campaigns spending money on audiences with very low conversion probability, audiences that overlap heavily with organic buyers, or segments below the profitability threshold. Suggests

reallocating that budget to untapped, high-potential segments instead.

API: Reporting API + Audiences API

5.7 Subscribe & Save Opportunity Finder

Identifies one-time purchasers of subscription-eligible products who did not subscribe. Creates a targeted audience for Subscribe & Save promotion campaigns. Recurring revenue is significantly more valuable than one-time sales, making this a high-impact optimization.

API: Audiences API + Reporting API

6. Automation Features

These are set-and-forget features. Once configured, they run on a schedule without any manual work, continuously keeping campaigns optimized.

How AMC Automation Works: The Workflow API lets you schedule SQL queries to run on a recurring basis (daily to every 21 days). When a query creates an audience, that audience auto-refreshes on your schedule and stays active in DSP or Sponsored Ads. Without refresh, audiences deactivate after 30 days.

6.1 Cart Abandonment Retargeting (Auto-Pilot)

Automatically maintains a live audience of shoppers who added products to cart but did not complete the purchase. The audience refreshes daily so new cart abandoners are always captured. This audience feeds directly into retargeting campaigns with tailored messaging like discount offers or urgency cues. This is one of the highest-converting AMC use cases — these shoppers already showed strong purchase intent.

API: Audiences API (daily schedule) + DSP/Sponsored Ads API | Priority: High

6.2 Lapsed Buyer Win-Back

Automatically detects customers who purchased 3-12 months ago but have not engaged since. Creates and refreshes a segment of these lapsed buyers on a weekly basis. Feeds them into re-engagement campaigns featuring new products, bundles, or special offers to bring them back.

API: Audiences API (weekly schedule) + Workflow API | Priority: High

6.3 Automated Cross-Sell Engine

Analyzes purchase patterns to find products frequently bought together. Automatically builds audiences of buyers of Product A who have not bought complementary Product B. Refreshes weekly to capture new buyers. Example: someone who bought a camera lens gets served ads for a compatible camera bag.

API: Audiences API + Reporting API (weekly schedule) | Priority: Medium

6.4 Dynamic Lookalike Audience Refresh

Takes the best-performing customer segment (e.g., high lifetime value buyers) as a seed and automatically regenerates lookalike audiences every week. This keeps the lookalike pool fresh and aligned with current buyer behavior rather than outdated patterns from months ago.

API: Audiences API (lookalike, weekly schedule) | Priority: High

6.5 New-to-Brand Rate Auto-Monitor

Runs NTB analysis on all active campaigns on a daily schedule. When a campaign's NTB rate drops below a set threshold, it triggers an alert recommending budget be shifted to higher-NTB campaigns. Optionally can auto-pause campaigns that consistently fail to attract new customers.

API: Reporting API (daily schedule) + Sponsored Ads API | Priority: Medium

6.6 Frequency Cap Auto-Adjustment

Monitors ad frequency per audience segment daily. When frequency exceeds the optimal range (as determined by the Optimal Frequency Finder), automatically adjusts DSP frequency caps to prevent ad fatigue and wasted impressions. No manual checking needed.

API: Reporting API (daily schedule) + DSP API | Priority: Medium

6.7 Scheduled Performance Digest

Automatically generates weekly or monthly performance summaries combining AMC insights (attribution, NTB, incrementality, frequency) with standard campaign metrics. Delivered as a ready-to-read report without any manual effort from the seller.

API: Reporting API (scheduled) + Workflow API | Priority: Low

6.8 Subscribe & Save Auto-Targeting

Continuously identifies new one-time purchasers of subscription-eligible products and automatically adds them to a Subscribe & Save promotion audience. Refreshes daily to catch every new purchaser. Turns one-time buyers into recurring revenue on autopilot.

API: Audiences API (daily schedule) + Sponsored Ads API | Priority: Medium

7. Limitations to Keep in Mind

AMC is powerful but has constraints your features need to account for:

- **1-2 Day Data Delay:** AMC data is not real-time. All monitoring and automation features work on a slight delay. Real-time bid adjustments should continue using the standard Sponsored Ads API.
- **Minimum Audience Size of 2,000:** Any audience segment must contain at least 2,000 users. Niche products or new sellers may not hit this threshold for all segments. Features should gracefully handle this with suggestions to broaden criteria.
- **Minimum Reporting Threshold of 100:** Aggregated reporting results require at least 100 users per group for privacy. Very granular breakdowns may return empty.
- **48-Hour Audience Activation Time:** New audiences take up to 48 hours to become available for campaign targeting after creation.
- **Audience Expiry:** Audiences without auto-refresh deactivate after 30 days. All automated features must include scheduled refresh.
- **SQL Complexity:** All AMC queries are SQL-based. Features should abstract this behind pre-built templates and a user-friendly interface.
- **Query Compute Costs:** While AMC is free, complex queries use AWS compute. Poorly written queries can be expensive. Optimize query templates carefully.
- **DSP MSA Required for Full Access:** Some features require an executed DSP Master Service Agreement. Sellers using only Sponsored Ads get a subset of capabilities.

8. Quick Reference: All 22 Features

A complete at-a-glance table of every feature, its category, the APIs it uses, and whether it runs on a schedule.

#	Feature	Category	Key API	Auto?
1	Customer Journey Dashboard	Monitor	Reporting	
2	Multi-Touch Attribution	Monitor	Reporting	
3	Frequency Monitor	Monitor	Reporting	
4	NTB Tracker	Monitor	Reporting	
5	Audience Overlap Dashboard	Monitor	Reporting	
6	Campaign Health Alerts	Monitor	Reporting + Ads	✓
7	YoY Performance Comparison	Monitor	Reporting	
8	Incrementality Budget Allocation	Optimize	Reporting	
9	Custom Audience Builder	Optimize	Audiences	
10	Optimal Frequency Finder	Optimize	Reporting	
11	Path-to-Conversion Optimizer	Optimize	Reporting	
12	Lookalike Targeting	Optimize	Audiences	
13	Ad Spend Waste Detector	Optimize	Reporting + Aud.	
14	Subscribe & Save Finder	Optimize	Audiences	
15	Cart Abandonment Retargeting	Automate	Audiences + Ads	✓
16	Lapsed Buyer Win-Back	Automate	Audiences	✓
17	Cross-Sell Engine	Automate	Audiences + Rep.	✓
18	Dynamic Lookalike Refresh	Automate	Audiences	✓
19	NTB Rate Auto-Monitor	Automate	Reporting + Ads	✓
20	Frequency Cap Auto-Adjust	Automate	Reporting + DSP	✓
21	Scheduled Performance Digest	Automate	Reporting	✓
22	Subscribe & Save Auto-Target	Automate	Audiences + Ads	✓

Bottom Line: AMC gives you 22 features across monitoring, optimization, and automation that are simply not possible with the standard Amazon Ads API alone. The 8 automation features run on autopilot once set up, continuously working to recover lost sales, acquire new customers, and reduce wasted spend.

AMC features and APIs are subject to change. Refer to the official Amazon Ads API documentation for the latest specifications.